

Attn: Composers

2027 Penn State INTERNATIONAL NEW-MUSIC FESTIVAL AND SYMPOSIUM CALL FOR SCORES

August 1, 2026 – University Park, PA

Email contact: Baljinder Sekhon, Festival Director bss5477@psu.edu

VISIT FESTIVAL WEBSITE: <https://sites.psu.edu/pennstatecomposition/penn-state-international-new-music-festival-and-symposium/>

Online Composition Submission Form: <https://forms.gle/zx4xbHsnYo7awGqs8>

SUBMISSION DEADLINE: Friday September 4, 2026 11:59pm EST

The Penn State University School of Music will be holding the 4th Biennial International New-Music Festival and Symposium March 18-20, 2027. The festival will consist of multiple concerts and research presentation sessions, featuring the work of composers and scholars selected through an international call for scores and research proposals. Selected composer participants will attend the festival in person, work with performers, network with other participants and within the Penn State community, and hear their compositions presented on a festival concert. Selected scholars will present a paper/presentation on any topic related to contemporary music. The festival concerts will feature performances by Penn State faculty and student performers, Penn State large ensembles, chamber ensembles, and guest ensemble Anzû Quartet. Composers can submit up to two works total and can select from 31 categories/genres for submission.

Participant Eligibility:

1. Composers and scholars of any nationality and age are encouraged to apply.
2. **Selected participants are expected to attend the festival in person.** The Penn State School of Music might be able to provide modest travel or lodging funding for selected participants who do not have access to funding assistance from institutions or other sources.*
3. Faculty and Students currently enrolled at Penn State are not eligible to submit compositions or research presentations through this call for scores/proposals. There is a separate internal call for students currently enrolled at Penn State.
4. A maximum of three Penn State alumni will be selected for the festival: one in each category of acoustic composition, electronic composition, and paper/presentation.
5. The 31 genres/categories that are open for submission are listed below.

*Living Music and the Penn State Composition and Technology programs will assist with travel arrangements to and from the airport in State College if needed and provide lodging discounts through Penn State where possible. Dr. Baljinder Sekhon will provide a formal invitation for those seeking financial assistance from their institution, if needed. Living Music will make every effort to provide home stays for student composers and scholars, but this is not guaranteed. Funding assistance we can provide is very modest, but we will do everything possible to make this an equitable opportunity.

COMPOSITION

Composition Eligibility:

- Each composer may submit up to two pieces for consideration.
- Multiple submissions must be made in different categories.
- Each submission must be made with a new complete submission form.
- All submissions should be between 3-15 minutes in duration.
- Works composed in 2017 or later are eligible.
- Works integrating video are acceptable for any category.
- Previously performed compositions are eligible.
- Works of any style, aesthetic, and notation will be accepted.
- There is no entry fee to submit a work for consideration.
- Composers may provide their own performers or submit to one of the categories below.
- It is our hope that selected composers can attend the entire festival and symposium.
- Please note that there is no guarantee that a work will be selected for each of the categories available.

The following submission categories are possible:

1. Works with performers provided by composer (any instrumentation).
(composer agrees to provide performers for this category)
2. Works for solo instrument or voice.
(produced by Living Music and the Penn State Composition Program; Baljinder Sekhon, director)
3. Works for 1-5 performers with fixed or live electronics (with or without video, 1-12 channels).
Audio formats available: mono, stereo, quadrophonic, 5.1, 7.2, 7.2.4 Dolby Atmos
(produced by Paul Coleman and Sarah Genevieve Burghart-Rice)
4. Works for electronic playback only (with or without video, 1-12 channels).
Audio formats available: mono, stereo, quadrophonic, 5.1, 7.2, 7.2.4 Dolby Atmos
(produced by Paul Coleman and Sarah Genevieve Burghart-Rice)
5. Wind Ensemble (In addition to standard wind band instrumentation, the following instruments/doublings can be included: piano, harp, soprano saxophone, flugelhorn, English horn, contra clarinets and bassoon, piccolo, e-flat clarinet, accordion, bass guitar, and guitar)
(produced by Tonya Mitchell-Spradlin, Director of Wind Band Studies)
6. Saxophone Quartet or Ensemble (up to triple saxophone quartet plus bass saxophone)
(produced by David Stambler, Professor of Saxophone)
7. Percussion Ensemble (maximum of 8 players)
(produced by Lee Hinkle, Assistant Professor of Percussion)
8. Flute Ensemble (not to exceed six different parts, can include piccolo, flute, alto flute, and bass flute)
(produced by Naomi Seidman, Associate Professor of Flute)
9. Clarinet Quartet/Ensemble (up to but not exceeding: 2 Eb, 9 Bb, 1 alto, 4 Bass Cl (to Low C)., 1 Eb Contra Alto Cl., 1 BBb Contra Bass Clarinet)
(produced by Anthony J. Costa, Professor of Clarinet)
10. Bassoon Ensemble (3-6 parts, can include 1 contrabassoon)
(produced by Carlos Manuel López Soria, Assistant Teaching Professor of Bassoon)
11. Woodwind Quintet (C fl, Bb cl, ob, hrn, bsn, no doublings)
(produced by the Pennsylvania Quintet, performed by the Pennsylvania Quintet or Student Quintet)

12. Tuba/Euphonium Ensemble (6 parts minimum)
(produced by Velvet Brown, Professor of Tuba and Euphonium)
13. Horn Ensemble (5-8 parts)
(produced by Sarah Schouten, Assistant Professor of Horn)
14. Trumpet Ensemble (6-8 parts)
(produced by George Carpten IV, Assistant Professor of Trumpet)
15. Trombone Choir (6-8 parts)
(produced by Ben Carrasquillo, Assistant Professor of Trombone)
16. Brass Quintet
(produced by Velvet Brown, Professor of Tuba and Euphonium)
17. TTBB Choir (up to 8-part divisi, unaccompanied works, or those requiring piano or limited instrumental accompaniment)
(produced by the Penn State Glee Club; Christopher Kiver, director)
18. SSAA Choir (up to 8-part divisi, unaccompanied works, or those requiring piano or limited instrumental accompaniment)
(produced by Oriana Singers; Arreon Harley-Emerson, director)
19. SATB Choir (up to 8-part divisi, unaccompanied works, or those requiring piano or limited instrumental accompaniment)
(produced by Penn State Concert Choir: Christopher Kiver, director)
20. String Orchestra
(produced by Gerardo Edelstein, Director of Orchestral Studies)
21. Chamber Orchestra
(produced by Gerardo Edelstein, Director of Orchestral Studies)
22. Piano and Voice(s) (piano and 1-3 voices of any voice type)
(produced by Rachel Copeland, Associate Professor of Voice)
23. Oboe Trio (two oboes, one English horn)
(produced by Andreas Oeste, Professor of Oboe)
24. Tuba/Euphonium Quartet
(produced by Velvet Brown, Professor of Tuba and Euphonium)
25. Viola Quartet
(produced by the Penn State Graduate Viola Quartet)
26. Open Instrumentation (up to 15 performers. Graphic, text-based, non-traditional, or a mixture of notation styles preferred)
(produced by guest ensemble Open Music in collaboration with Other Arts Ensemble; Kevin Sims, Artistic Director)
27. Duo for Flute (c/alto) and Cello
(produced by JANO Duo: Naomi Seidman and Jonathan Dexter)
28. Pierrot + Percussion + Oboe (subsets of three or more)
(produced by Lee Hinkle, Assistant Professor of Percussion, and a faculty/graduate student ensemble)
29. Piano Four Hands or Piano Duo
(produced by Melody Quah, Assistant Professor of Piano)
30. Cello Choir (4-5 parts)
(produced by Jonathan Dexter, Visiting Assistant Professor of Cello and Digital Performance)
31. Anzû Quartet (violin, Bb clarinet, cello, piano)
(produced by guest ensemble Anzû Quartet)

If the composer intends to provide their own performers, the composer must indicate so on the submission form. If this is the case, the composer may utilize **any** instrumentation and **any** amount of players.*

* If a composer would like to provide their own percussionist(s) but utilize the percussion instruments available at Penn State, please provide a clear list of required percussion instruments with the submission.

Composition Submission Guidelines:

- Submissions will only be accepted online. No hard copy submissions will be accepted.
- Submission Deadline: September 4, 2026 (11:59pm EDT)
- Each composer may submit up to two pieces for consideration.
- Multiple submissions must be made in different categories.
- Each submission must be made with a new complete submission form.
- Submissions should include links to a legible score (unless irrelevant) and recording.
- Recordings are encouraged but not required.
- Scores and recordings should be uploaded to an online file sharing service and remain available until November 1, 2026. The recording link can be hosted on YouTube, SoundCloud, or a similar streaming service.
- Submissions should include brief program notes.
- Submissions should include a brief biography (100 words maximum).
- Submissions including electronics must include a complete list of technical needs (and if necessary, a routing diagram).

COMPOSITION ONLINE SUBMISSION FORM: <https://forms.gle/zx4xbHsnYo7awGqs8>

For additional information, please email Dr. Baljinder Sekhon: bss5477@psu.edu

Selected composers will be informed no later than October 19, 2026.
